

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	O – Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (DSNAP)
	Section No./Name	O-200-DSNAP Implementation
	Document No./Name	O-210-DSNAP Pre-Conditions
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Implementation of a DSNAP is not appropriate for every disaster. The decision to implement a DSNAP must be made based on several factors. A DSNAP should only be implemented in cases where it is not practical to operate the regular SNAP.

The following pre-conditions must be met before implementation of a DSNAP can be authorized:

- Commercial channels of food distribution (wholesale and retail food outlets) must have been both disrupted and subsequently restored such that they are now currently available, and
- The regular SNAP must be unable to handle the increased number of households needing SNAP assistance in a timely manner.

Commercial channels of food distribution are considered to be disrupted under any of the following conditions, as long as the condition was directly caused by the disaster:

- Retail food outlets are closed for a significant period of time.
- Normal operating hours of food outlets are reduced to the extent that a household's opportunity to purchase food supplies is significantly reduced.
- Power failure significantly restricts the operation of food outlets.
- Household access to retail food outlets is limited because of damage to roads, bridges, or mass transit within the disaster area.
- Reduced supplies of food and/or unusually heavy demand for food exist, causing a significant reduction in households' opportunities to purchase food.
- Delivery of food supplies to food outlets is significantly hampered.

Commercial channels of food distribution are considered to be restored when conditions have improved to the extent that households have reasonable access to food outlets with sufficient food supplies.